



Radical ASOIAF theories

Fans of ASOIAF or GoT spend the long gaps between seasons, and the even longer gaps between books by indulging in metadiscussions. <http://digit.in/gottheories>



The Influences of Altered Carbon

From Blade Runner to The Matrix, this article unravels every sci fi franchise that had an influence on Altered Carbon. <http://digit.in/altcarb>



MEMORY, SORROW, THORN

Memory, Sorrow, Thorn is a more streamlined version of GoT. In fact, GRRM was heavily influenced by the series while crafting ASOIAF. The hero is a Simon Snowlock, and the heroine is Miramele, a princess who goes about disguised as a boy and is named Marya. There are ice dragons, fire dancers, large wolves, and mysterious others. The magical side of fantasy is explored in more depth than ASOIAF.

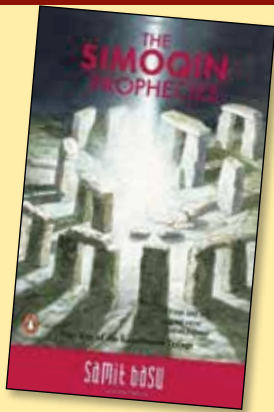
BARTIMAEUS SEQUENCE

The Bartimaeus Sequence is a smarter and grittier version of Harry Potter. It is what happens in a world where wizards enforce their control over muggles, instead of hiding in secret. The magical powers are through the summoning of demons. This is a tragicomic story, of a young minister in the wizarding government. The series has just the right mixture of emotion, spectacle and deadpan humour.



THE SILMARILLION

This is a relatively small book, but is dense and packed with stories. So much so that the entire sequence of events in The Hobbit and the Lord of the Rings are summed up in a single paragraph. The events follow the very creation of middle earth, and the efforts of the many Valar. What is in The Silmarillion is even more epic than any representation of Tolkien's works we have seen in video form so far.

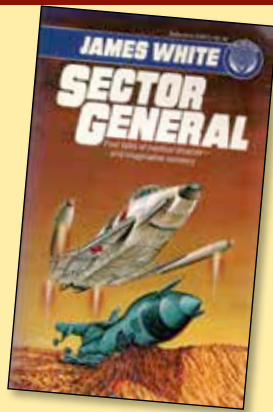
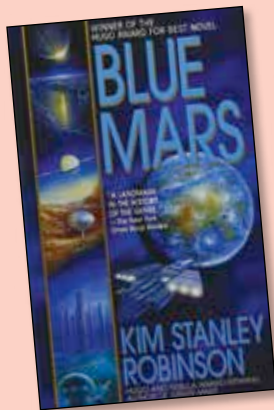


GAMEWORLD TRILOGY

Indian author Samit Basu has written the Gameworld Trilogy, a series of books that would do incredibly well as a TV series. All kinds of fantasy elements are thrown in, including centaurs, ninjas, giant cats, knights, manticores, aliens, rakshasas and shapeshifters. At very rare times, you are pulled out of the world into a celestial plane where it is revealed that the entire world is an experiment.

MARS TRILOGY

The Mars Trilogy is relevant now more than ever as there are multiple plans to establish a permanent human settlement on the Red Planet. The Mars Trilogy goes a step beyond just establishing a colony. Through the three books, Red Mars, Blue Mars and Green Mars, we follow the efforts to geo-engineer the planet, and completely terraform Mars to make it fit for human habitation.



SECTOR GENERAL

After an interstellar war, humans establish the Sector General hospital to care for extraterrestrials. All the drama in this series would be provided by a group of doctors from various alien species trying to provide healthcare to other aliens in distress. The most interesting thing here is the sheer range of creatures from different worlds, with believable physiologies from the distant reaches of space.